

Monica Cholico

Front-End Software Engineer

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Dear Steven Speicher,

I'm a front-end engineer at The New York Times, and I'm writing to express my interest in the Software Engineer position on the Games SUB Squad. I've spent the past almost five years building interactive web experiences at the Times, and what draws me to this role is the chance to bring those skills to a product that millions of people love — and to grow as an engineer on a team that values continuous improvement and is clearly looking for someone eager to deepen their backend skills over time.

In my current role, I work on the FlexSuite — the template system that powers custom creative experiences across NYT's digital platforms. I've built and maintained ad-format versions of Crossword, Wordle, and Connections, turning them into reusable templates that ad producers can configure without engineering support. While the codebase differs from what the Games team uses, I understand these products from the inside: how players interact with them, what makes the experience feel right, and the editorial care that goes into every detail. I'd be excited to bring that familiarity and my frontend experience to the actual Games product.

My day-to-day work is in JavaScript, HTML, and CSS, building modular, accessible, responsive components with modern frameworks. Over the past two years, my team has also started integrating Astro, TypeScript, and Svelte into our stack. I have experience with React from a previous role at Brokerage Engine, where I built features across React and GraphQL on the front-end and Ruby on Rails on the back-end. While React hasn't been my primary framework recently outside of personal projects, I'm eager to deepen those skills — and this role's focus on frontend web experiences with the opportunity to grow into backend development is exactly the kind of trajectory I'm looking for.

Outside of work, I've built projects that reflect both my technical range and my drive to keep learning. Planeta Mujer (planeta-mujer.org) is an interactive data visualization platform I designed and coded from scratch using D3.js, Canvas API, and scroll-driven navigation. I'm also migrating a personal blog from WordPress to Astro, adding scrollytelling articles along the way. My portfolio site is a custom Three.js application with GLSL shaders. And I've been using AI-assisted development tools — Cursor, Claude, and Copilot — to build a workflow automation prototype that integrates Slack and Jira. These projects keep me curious and push me to learn new tools and patterns, which is how I like to work.

What excites me most about this opportunity is the combination of a product I already care about, a team that values growth, and work that directly impacts how millions of subscribers experience the Times. I'd love the chance to contribute to that.

Sincerely,

Monica Cholico